

ANCIENT HISTORY



MODULE – 22

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

PART - 2

OUR APPROACH TO FIND HISTORY FROM MYSTERY?

PRE - HISTORY

The period of time before written records.

- Stone Age
- Metal Age

PROTO - HISTORY

IVC

Aryan Invasion

VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 500 B.C.)

EARLY VEDIC AGE
(1500 – 1000 B.C.)

LATER VEDIC AGE
(1000 – 500 B.C.)

RELIGION & PHILOSOPHY



JAINISM



BUDDHISM

HISTORIC PERIOD

MAHAJANAPADAS

TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

MAGADHA

NANDA DYNASTY

Alexander Invasion

MAURYAN DYNASTY

SANGAM AGE

MAURYAN DYNASTY

GUPTA DYNASTY

Foreign Invasion

KUSHAN EMPIRE

SATAVAHANAS

PUSHYABHUTHI DYNASTY

Huns Invasion

CHALUKYAS

PALLAVAS

MAUKHARIS

VAKATAKAS

KADAMBAS

CHOLA

CHERA

PANDYA



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

ABOUT THE DYNASTY

SOURCES

KINGS AND THEIR CONTRIBUTION

CONSOLIDATION OF EMPIRE AND TERRITORIAL EXTENT

POLITICAL STRUCTURE/ SOCIAL LIFE/ ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE DYNASTY

HOW DYNASTY DECLINED

OTHER FACTS

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

HARSHAVARDHANA

Position of women was not satisfactory. The institution of **Swyamvara** had declined..

Dowry become common. The practice of **sati** was prevalent.

There **existed many sub castes**. Sudras practiced agriculture. Land grants to brahmins continues

The **fourfold division** of the society – Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vysya and Sudra – was prevalent.

Banabhatta and Hiuen Tsang mention about the social life in the times of Harsha.

Remarriage of widows was not permitted, particularly among the higher castes

Burial - three ways of disposal of the dead – **cremation, water burial and exposure in the woods.**

SOCIAL LIFE

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

OBSERVATION OF HIUEN TSANG

ON SOCIETY

Chandals position degraded.



Forced labour - called as vishti, was rare.



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

OBSERVATION OF HIUEN TSANG

ON SOCIETY

There were incidence of robbery



There were severe punishments including mutilation of body parts and capital punishments as was in Mauryan Administration.



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PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

HARSHAVARDHANA

ECONOMY OF HARSHA

1

Trade and commerce had declined

The decline of trade centres

Slow activities of merchant guilds

Number of coins reduced

2

Handicrafts industry and agriculture were affected

Farmers and manufacturers began to **produce less** as there was no large scale demand for goods

Subsistence economy

Rise of **self-sufficient village economy**. We can see economy shifting from urban to rural.

In short, there was a sharp economic decline as compared to the economy of the Gupta period.

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHA'S ARMY

FOUR DIVISION



CAVALRY



ELEPHANTS



INFANTARY



CHARIOTS

The number of cavalry was more than one lakh and the elephants more than sixty thousands. This was much more than that of the Mauryan army.

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

SIGNIFICANCE

1

Contribution to literature

BANABHATTA

- Harshacharita and
- Kadambari

HARSHAVARDHAN - THREE PLAYS

- Ratnavali
- Priyadarsika AND
- Nagananda

MATANGA DIVAKARA and BARTHRIHARI

(Poet, Philosopher & Grammarian)

HIUEN TSANG

- Si-yu-Ki (journey to west)
- Visited the Nalanda University and remained as a student.

PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

SIGNIFICANCE

2 Contribution to Art and Architecture during Harsha period was very less.

- 1**
- Hiuen Tsang describes the glory of the **monastery with many storeys** built by Harsha **at Nalanda**.
 - He also speaks of a **copper statue of Buddha** with eight feet in height.



- 2** The **brick temple of Lakshmana at Sirpur** with its rich architecture is assigned to the period of Harsha.



PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

NALANDA UNIVERSITY

8 Apart from lectures, discussion played an important part. The medium of instruction was Sanskrit.

7 **General subjects** like logic, grammar, astronomy, medicine and art; along with Vedas, Hinayana doctrine, Sankhya and Yoga **philosophies** were taught.

6 It was **maintained with the revenue derived from 100 to 200 villages** endowed by different rulers.

5 **Education was free**
But entrance examination tough.



Hinayana University of Valabhi and the Mahayana University of Nalanda were famous educational institution of ancient india

1 Term **Nalanda** means “**giver of knowledge**”. It was an institution of advanced learning and research

2 **Founded by Kumaragupta I** during the Gupta period. It was **patronized by his successors and later by Harsha**.

3 The professors of the University were called *Panditas*. **Renowned professors** were Dingnaga, Dharmapala, Sthiramati and Silabadhra.

4 It was **residential university** with capacity of 3000 students and it attracted scholars from various parts of the world.

MAITRAKAS

Maitrakas were tributary chiefs of the Guptas

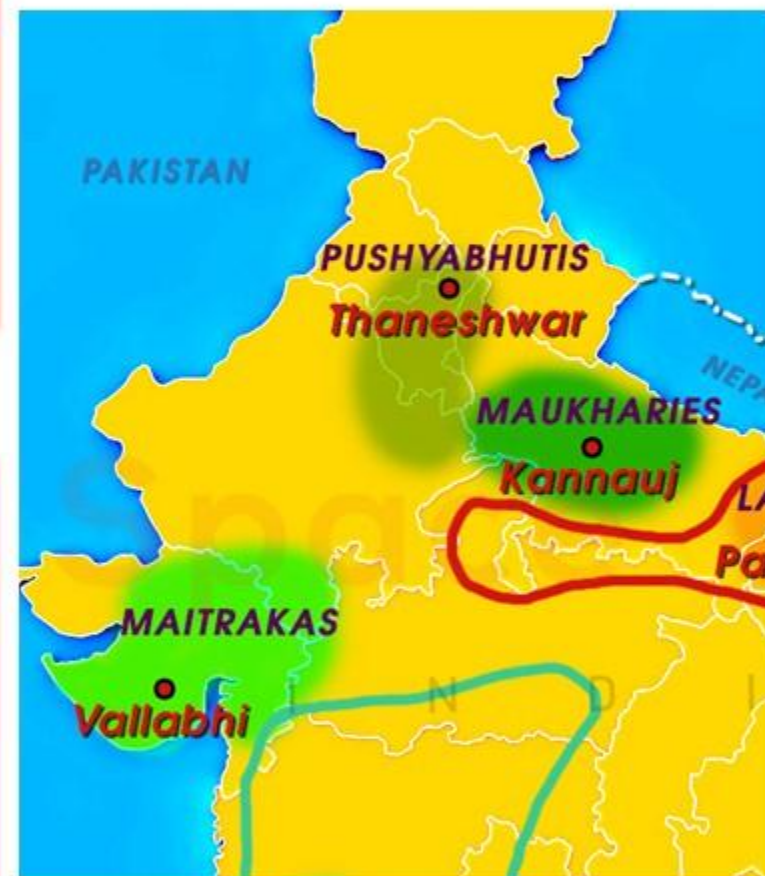
Contemporary of Harsha Vardhana.

One important king Dhruvasena II was married to **Harshavardhan** daughter.

Maitrakas developed Vallabhi as their capital, which was also an important centre of learning

Being on the Arabian Sea, it was also a port town having flourishing trade and commerce.

Maitrakas continued to rule until the middle of the 8th century when Arab attacks weakened their power



MAUKHARIS

Subordinate rulers of the Guptas and used the title of *samanta*

They ruled over Kannauj, a city in western Uttar Pradesh

Contemporary of Harsha Vardhana.

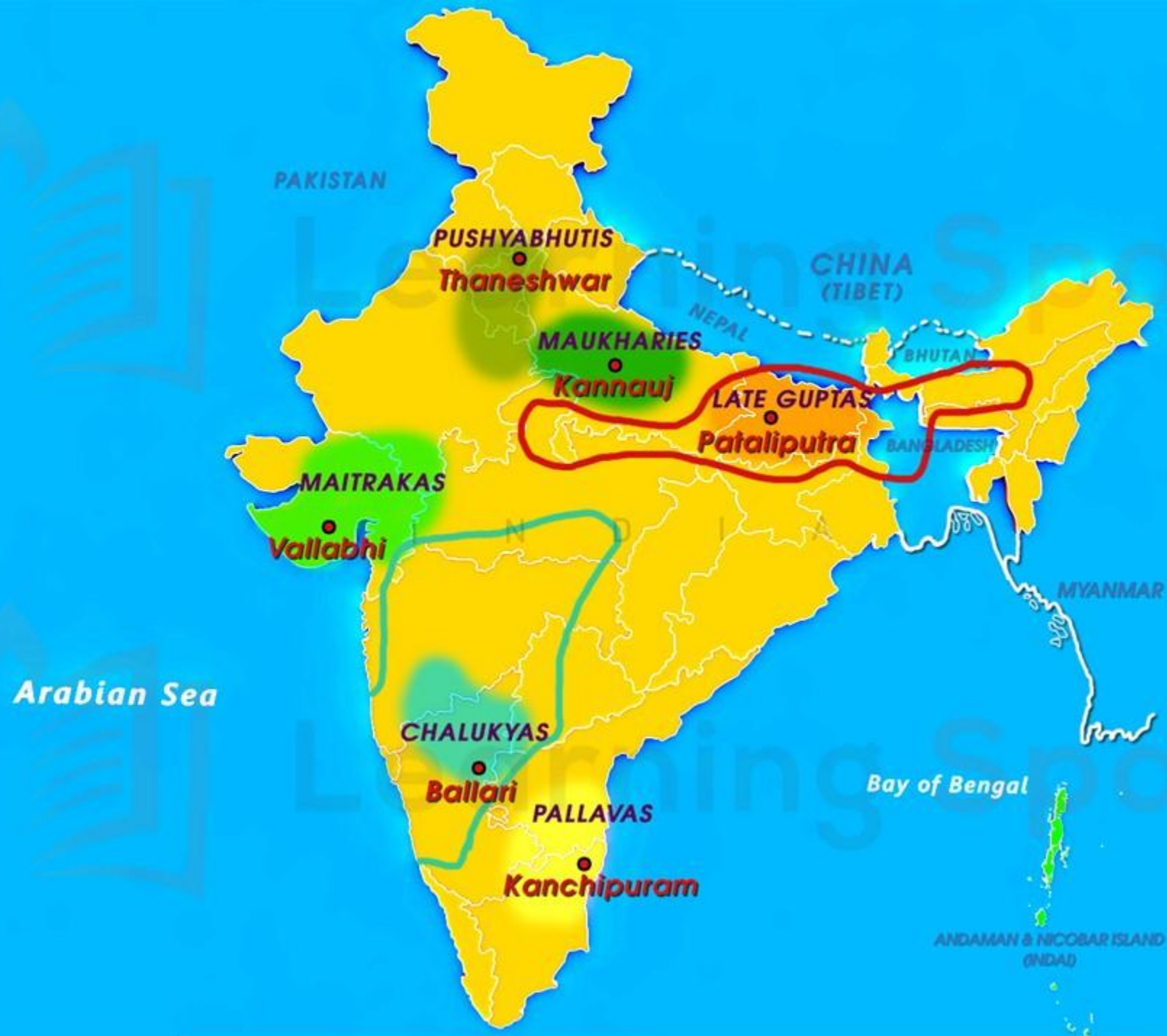


One important king Grahavarman was married to **Harshavardhan** sister Rajyashri.

Gradually the Maukhari family disappeared into **obscurity**.

After the successful expedition of Harsha, the kingdom of Kannauj, was then merged with that of the Pushyabhutis and Harsha shifted his capital from Thanesar (Kurukshetra) to Kannauj

Shashanka, the ruler of Bengal (Gauda), and Devagupta, the ruler of Malwa, jointly attacked Grahavarmana and killed him.



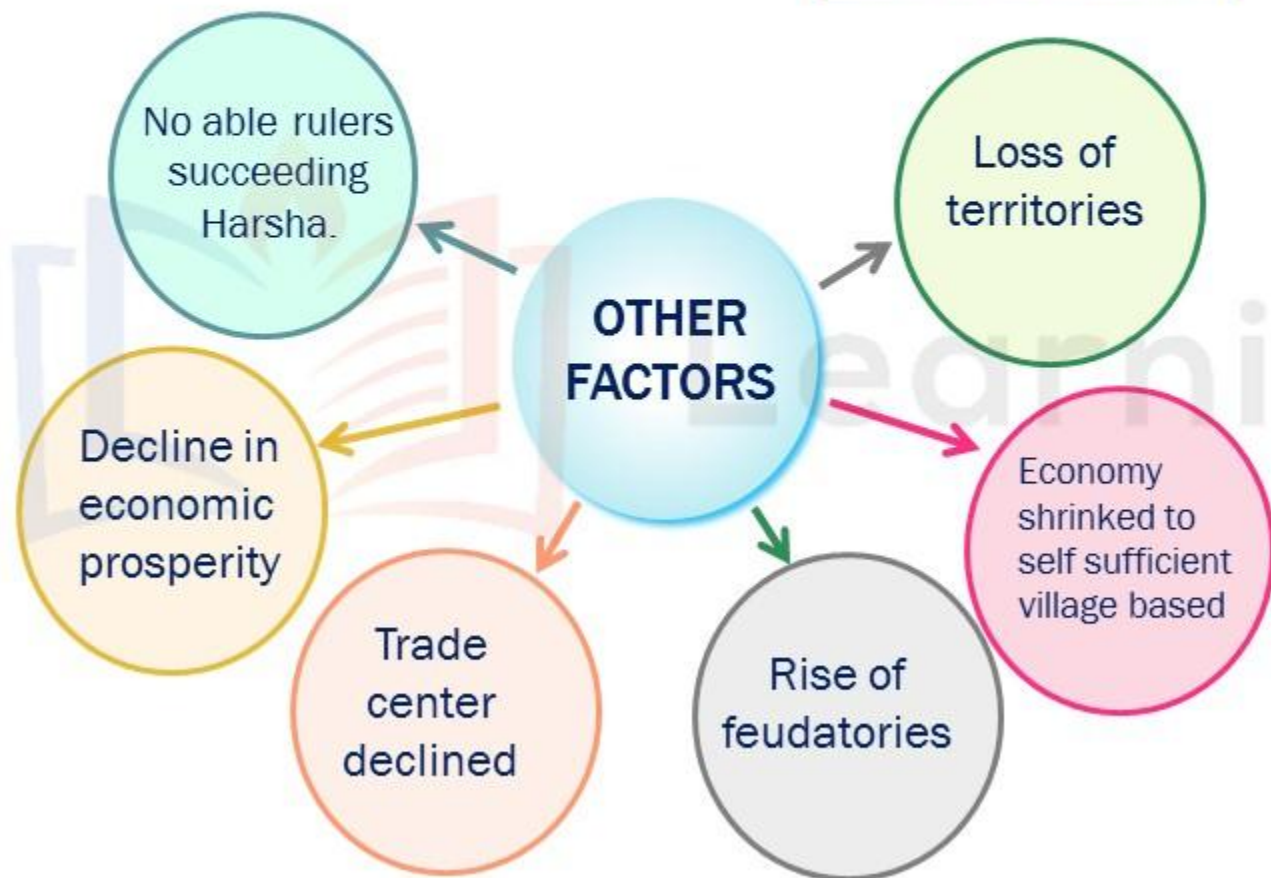
PUSHYABHUTI DYNASTY

(590 AD TO 647 AD)

HARSHAVARDHANA

(606 AD TO 647 AD)

DECLINE



1 The death of Harsha was followed by a period of **political confusion** that continued up to the 8th century.

2 The **Gurjara Pratiharas** and the **Rajput rulers** emerged as a big force in northern India subsuming major part of Pushyabhuti dynasty

Q.1 On the bank of which river Pulakesin II defeated Harshavardhana?

- a) Beas river
- b) Narmada river
- c) Godavari river
- d) Chambal river

ANSWER

b)

- Q.2** Assertion (A) : Harshavardhana convened the Prayag Assembly.
Reason (R) : He wanted to popularizes only the Mahayan form the Buddhism.
Codes :
- a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
 - b) Both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
 - c) A is true but R is false
 - d) A is false but R is true

ANSWER a)

Q.3 Which one of the following inscription mentions Pulkesin II military success against Harshavardhana?

- a) Allahabad Pillar Inscription
- b) Aihole Inscription
- c) Hathigumpa Inscription
- d) Mehrauli Inscription

ANSWER

b)

THOUGHT PROVOKING QUESTIONS**Q.1**

Write a short note on “NALANDA MAHAVIRA”?

Q.2

Harsha is described as “the lord of the whole of north India”. Determine the extent of his empire and discuss the socio-economic condition of those time.

Q.3

Give an account of Hieun-Tsang on Harsha’s administration, Society and Economy. Compare with Gupta dynasty.

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